

Patient Appointment Booking Form — Basic Fields Use Case

1. Aim

To design and build a functional “Patient Appointment Booking Form” application in Zoho Creator that demonstrates the correct usage of all thirteen Basic Fields available in the Form Builder, while solving a real healthcare front-desk requirement of scheduling patient appointments in a structured manner.

2. Introduction

The front desk of a multi-specialty clinic receives appointment requests through phone calls and walk-ins, leading to double-bookings, missed follow-ups, and no structured record of a patient’s symptoms or medical history before the consultation. Doctors often have no visibility into a patient’s condition until the patient arrives.

This experiment uses the low-code platform Zoho Creator to build a single online form through which a patient can submit an appointment request. The form captures personal identity, contact details, department preference, symptoms, existing conditions, preferred schedule, and consent for treatment, using every Basic Field type provided by the Form Builder.

2.1 Application Details

Item	Description
Application Name	Patient Appointment & Scheduling Management
Form Name	Appointment_Booking_Form
Report Name	Appointment_Booking_Report
Primary Users	Patients / Front-desk (Reception) staff
Report Objective	Enable the front desk and doctors to filter, confirm, and schedule patient appointments

3. Basic Fields Used and Their Mapping

Table 1 maps every Basic Field from the Zoho Creator Form Builder palette to its role in the Patient Appointment Booking Form.

Basic Field	Form Field Name	Purpose	Sample Value
Name	Patient_Name	Captures the full name of the patient using First/Last name subfields	Meera Krishnan
Email	Email_Address	Captures a validated email address for sending the appointment confirmation	meera.krishnan@example.com
Address	Residential_Address	Captures the full residential address with city, state, and pincode	22, Nehru Street, Madurai, TN, 625001
Phone	Contact_Number	Captures a validated mobile number for the clinic to call and confirm	+91 98400 11223
Single Line	Referred_By	Short free-text entry for a referring doctor or source of referral	Dr. S. Balaji, General Physician
Multi Line	Symptoms_Description	Free-text description of current symptoms or reason for visit	Persistent headache and mild fever for the past 3 days.
Number	Age	Numeric value with validation for the patient's age	34
Date	Preferred_Appointment_Date	Preferred date of consultation using a date picker	05-Aug-2026
Time	Preferred_Appointment_Time	Preferred time slot for the consultation	10:30 AM
Drop Down	Department	Single-select list of hospital departments / specializations	General Medicine
Radio	Gender	Single mandatory selection among mutually exclusive options	Female
Multi Select	Existing_Conditions	Selection of one or more pre-existing conditions or allergies	Diabetes, Allergy to Penicillin
Checkbox	Consent_For_Treatment	Patient's consent to proceed with examination and treatment	Checked (Agreed)

Table 1: Mapping of Zoho Creator Basic Fields to the Appointment Booking Form

4. Form Layout (Section-wise)

Section A — Patient Details

- Patient Name (First Name, Last Name)
- Age (Number field)
- Gender (Radio: Male / Female / Other)

Section B — Contact Details

- Email Address (Email field)
- Contact Number (Phone field)
- Residential Address (Address field)

Section C — Medical Details

- Referred By (Single Line)
- Department (Drop Down)
- Existing Conditions (Multi Select)
- Symptoms Description (Multi Line)

Section D — Scheduling & Consent

- Preferred Appointment Date (Date field)
- Preferred Appointment Time (Time field)
- I consent to examination and treatment (Checkbox)

5. Procedure

1. **Log in and create the application.** Sign in to Zoho Creator and click Create Application → Create from scratch. Enter the application name “Patient Appointment & Scheduling Management” and click Create.
2. **Create the form.** Choose Create a new form (Start from scratch) and name it “Appointment_Booking_Form”. The Form Builder opens with the field palette on the left.
3. **Add the Section A fields.** Add a section heading “Patient Details”, then drag the following onto the canvas:
 - a) Name field → set Field Name “Patient Name” (link name Patient_Name) with First and Last name subfields.
 - b) Number field → rename to “Age”.
 - c) Radio field → rename to “Gender” and add the choices Male, Female, Other.
4. **Add the Section B fields.** Add a section heading “Contact Details”, then drag the Email field (“Email Address”), the Phone field (“Contact Number”), and the Address field (“Residential Address”).
5. **Add the Section C fields.** Add a section heading “Medical Details”, then drag:
 - a) Single Line → “Referred By”.
 - b) Drop Down → “Department” with choices such as General Medicine, Cardiology, Orthopedics, Pediatrics, Dermatology, and ENT.
 - c) Multi Select → “Existing Conditions” with choices such as Diabetes, Hypertension, Asthma, Thyroid Disorder, Allergy to Penicillin, and None.
 - d) Multi Line → “Symptoms Description”.
6. **Add the Section D fields.** Add a section heading “Scheduling & Consent”, then drag the Date field (“Preferred Appointment Date”), the Time field (“Preferred Appointment Time”), and

the Checkbox field (label: "I consent to examination and treatment", link name Consent_For_Treatment).

7. **Verify all 13 fields.** Confirm that every field name and link name matches Table 1, then click Save.
8. **Configure field validations.** Open each field's properties (Field Properties panel) and apply the rules listed in Table 2.
9. **Block past dates (script validation).** If the Date field settings do not directly restrict past dates, open Form Settings → Workflow → On Validate and add the following Deluge script:

```
if(input.Preferred_Appointment_Date < zoho.currentdate)
{
    alert "Preferred Appointment Date cannot be in the past.";
    cancel submit;
}
```

10. **Set up the confirmation email.** Go to Workflow → On Success (Create) and add the following Deluge script to send an automated email to the patient:

```
sendmail
[
    from : zoho.adminuserid
    to : input.Email_Address
    subject : "Appointment Request Received"
    message : "Dear " + input.Patient_Name.first_name + ","
              + " your appointment request for " + input.Department
              + " on " + input.Preferred_Appointment_Date
              + " has been received."
]
```

11. **Configure the report.** Open the auto-generated report and rename it "Appointment_Booking_Report". In the report's Quick View / Filter settings, add filters for Department and Preferred Appointment Date so the front desk can filter and confirm appointments.
12. **Publish the form.** Open the form's Share option and copy the public permalink so that the form can be shared on the clinic website or WhatsApp.
13. **Test the application.** Click Access Application and open the live form. Submit at least three sample records (see Table 3), confirm that validation messages appear for invalid input, and check that the records appear in Appointment_Booking_Report and that the confirmation email is received.

5.1 Validation Rules Configured

Field	Validation Applied
Patient Name, Phone, Age, Gender, Department, Preferred Appointment Date, Consent Checkbox	Marked as Mandatory (Required) fields.
Email Address	Built-in email format validation enabled.
Contact Number	Country-code format enabled for Indian numbers (+91).
Age	Value range restricted from 0 to 120.
Preferred Appointment Date	Past dates disallowed.
Consent_For_Treatment	Form cannot be submitted unless the checkbox is checked.

Table 2: Field-level validation rules

5.2 Workflow Summary

- Patient opens the public form link shared on the clinic website or WhatsApp.
- Patient fills in personal, contact, medical, and scheduling details across the four sections.
- On clicking Submit, Zoho Creator validates all mandatory fields and formats.
- A new record is created in the Appointment_Booking_Report.
- An automated confirmation email is sent to the patient using the Email field value.
- The front desk reviews the report, filters by Department and Preferred Appointment Date, and confirms the final slot with the concerned doctor.

5.3 Sample Records Used for Testing

#	Patient Name	Age	Gender	Department	Existing Conditions	Date	Time
1	Meera Krishnan	34	Female	General Medicine	Diabetes, Allergy to Penicillin	05-Aug-2026	10:30 AM
2	Rahul Verma	45	Male	Cardiology	Hypertension	06-Aug-2026	11:15 AM
3	Anitha Raj	8	Female	Pediatrics	None	07-Aug-2026	04:00 PM

Table 3: Sample appointment records

6. Screenshots

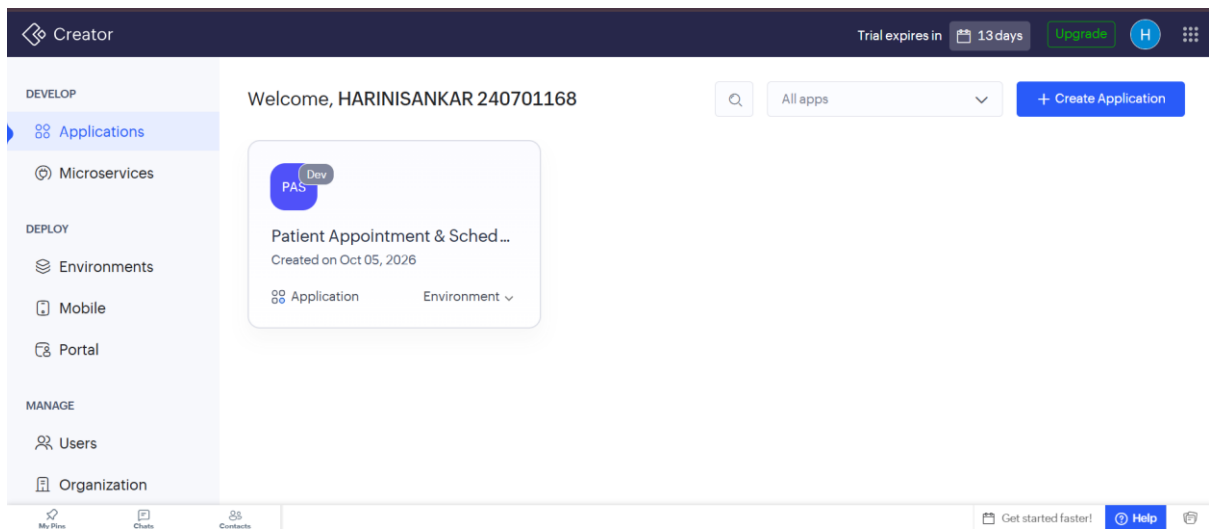


Figure 1: Application created in Zoho Creator — Patient Appointment & Scheduling Management

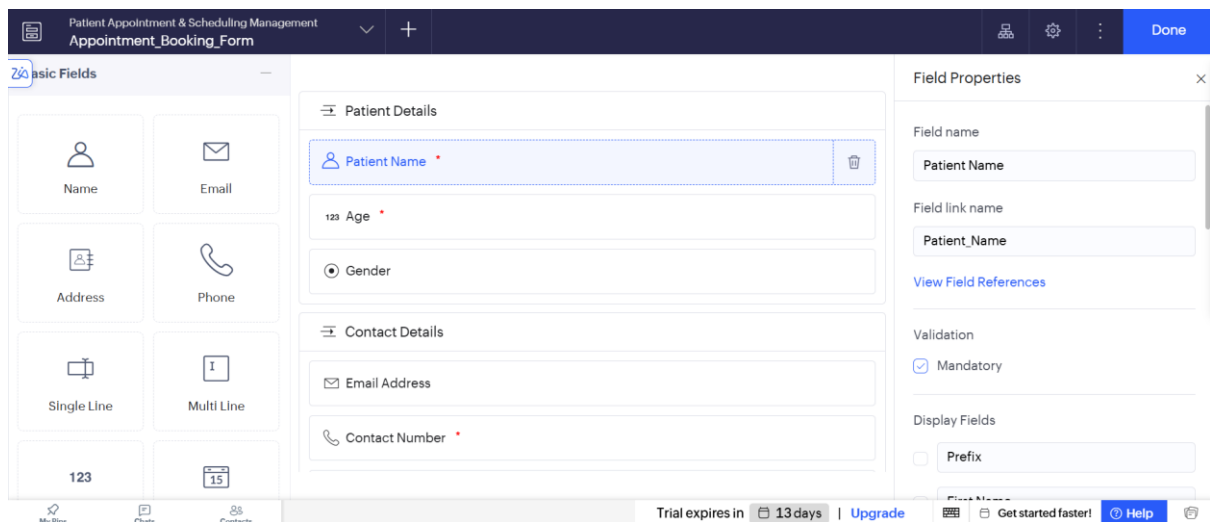


Figure 2: Appointment_Booking_Form in Form Builder showing all 13 Basic Fields

Figure 3: Field properties showing the validation rules (mandatory, Age range, Email, Phone)

Figure 4: Live preview of the Appointment_Booking_Form

Figure 5: Deluge scripts for date validation and confirmation email

Figure 6: Validation message displayed for invalid input

Patient Name	Email Address	Residential Address	Contact Number	Re
Harini Sankar	harinisankar2006@gmail.com	No.3, samraj nagar, 8th street, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, 600073, India	+918667324855	Di
Arjun Raman	arjun.raman@gmail.com	14, Gandhi Road, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, 600034, India	+919876543210	Di
Meera Krishnan	meerakrishnan@gmail.com	22, Nehru Street, Madurai, Tamil Nadu, 625001, India	+919840011223	Di

Showing 3 of 3

Figure 7: Appointment_Booking_Report showing at least three submitted records

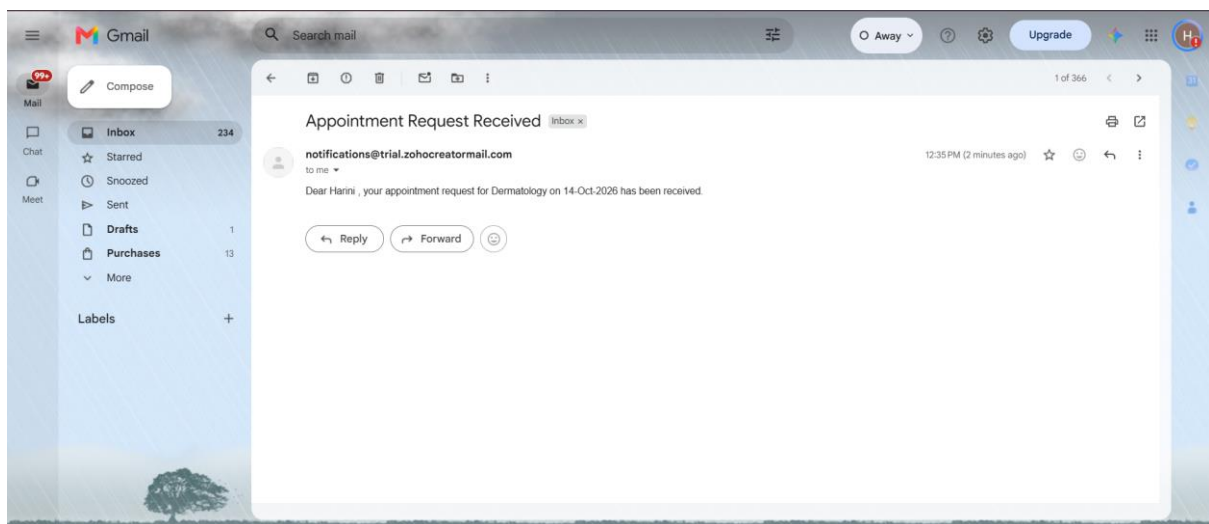


Figure 8: Confirmation email received by the patient

7. Result

The “Patient Appointment & Scheduling Management” application was successfully built in Zoho Creator. The Appointment_Booking_Form uses all thirteen Basic Fields — Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox — organized into four patient-friendly sections. The required field validations were applied, submitted appointments are stored in the Appointment_Booking_Report, and an automated confirmation email is sent to the patient, allowing the front desk to filter and confirm appointments efficiently.